Center for Black Student Excellence

Strategic Update



PORTLAND Public Schools

September 9, 2025

CENTER FOR BLACK STUDENT EXCELLENCE

Agenda

- Purpose
- The Current Moment
- Site Overview
- Benefits of One North
- Accessibility
- Risks + Mitigation
- Recommendation



Purpose

The Center for Black Student Excellence (CBSE) is both a place and a systems-level approach, born out of Portland Public Schools' 2018 visioning process to reimagine public education and affirmed by 75% of Portland voters through the 2020 bond.

We honor and express gratitude to the many community members, educators, and leaders who shaped this moment, engaging in authentic and courageous conversations that made CBSE possible.

CBSE represents a bold response to Portland's legacy of racial exclusion and displacement, particularly impacting Black communities from Albina. While open to all students, the Center is rooted in cultural affirmation and designed to integrate joy, healing, and excellence as essential conditions for learning.



The Current Moment

A Site Identified: Due Diligence in Motion

PPS has identified a potential site for the Center for Black Student Excellence headquarters, selected for its cultural significance, physical readiness, accessibility, and alignment with the community's vision.

This is not a rushed decision. It is the product of five years of engagement and the 194-page community vision document that continues to guide our steps.

We are now in the due diligence phase to assess feasibility, operational needs, and programmatic fit before final commitment.

CBSE is not just a building. It is a systems-level redesign and a living resource designed to advance student success and strengthen community connection.



Site Overview: One North Property

3506 - 3514 N Vancouver Ave., PDX | OR

Year Completed: 2015

Buildings: 2 (East, West)

Approximate Building Size:
East Bldg 37,900 SF | West Bldg 37,800 SF
Total SF: 75,700

Zoning: CM3

Central NE Portland; deep cultural relevance for Black Portlanders

Accessible, ADA compliant, move-in ready for partial programming

Proximate to Albina Vision Trust, Center for Black Excellence and historically Black neighborhoods



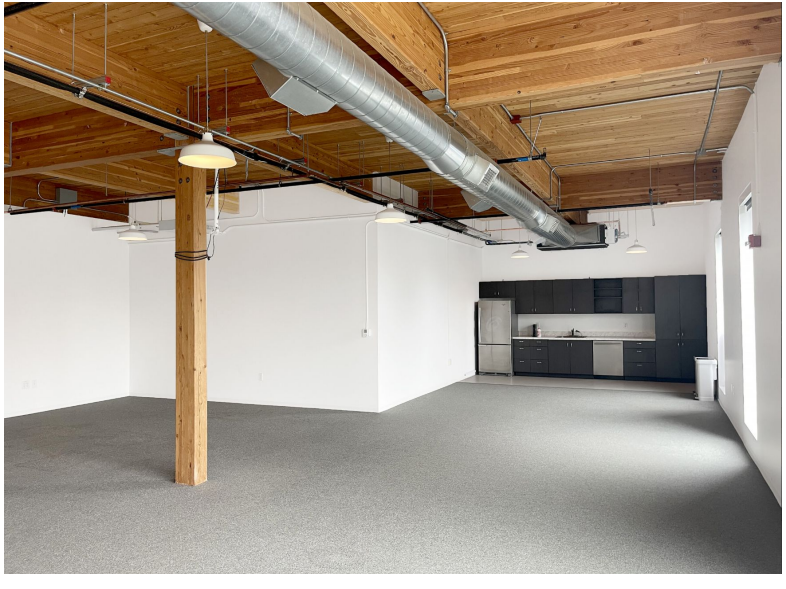


One North West

1st Floor:
7,950 SF

2nd Floor:
8,200 SF





3rd Floor:
8,200 SF

4th Floor:
7,500 SF

5th Floor:
5,950 SF

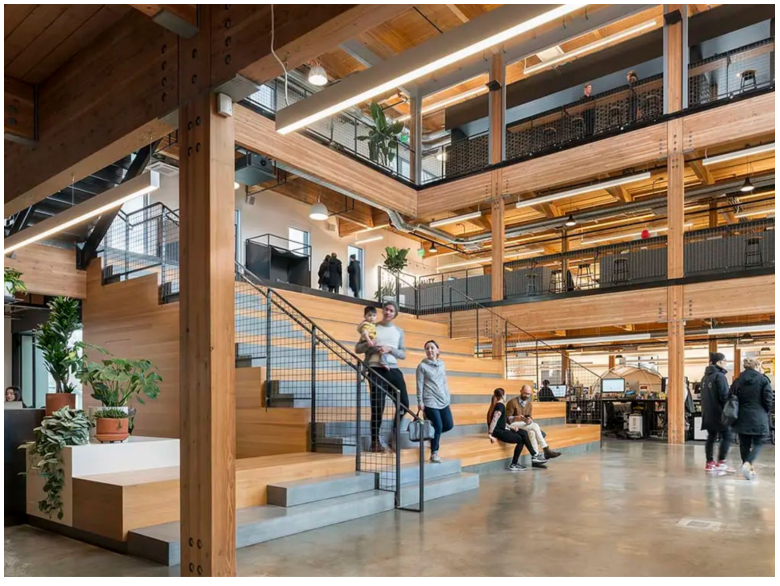


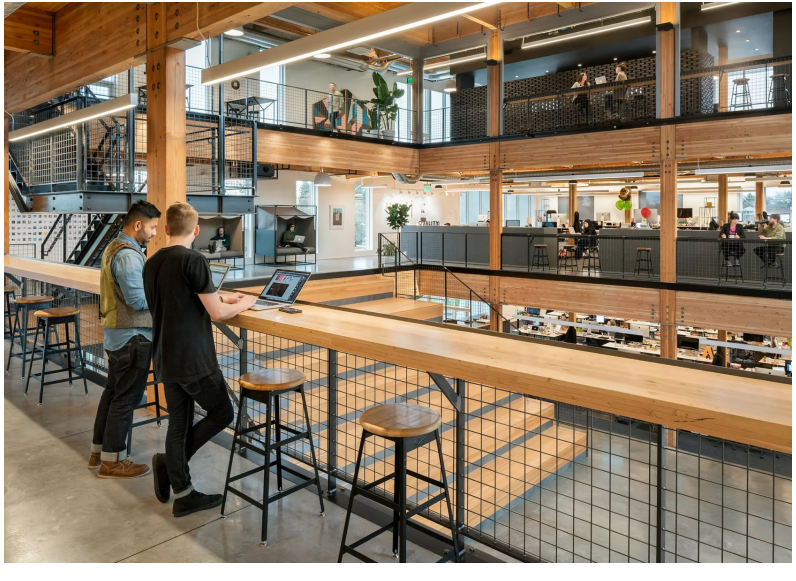


One North East

1st Floor:
7,600 SF

2nd Floor:
11,050 SF





3rd Floor:
10,150 SF

4th Floor:
9,100 SF




3514


ONE
WAY

Benefits of One North

Why One North Aligns With Our Vision

Cultural + Symbolic Fit

Return to Black-centered space in Albina

Builds trust with Black families & legacy institutions

Functional Readiness

Built in 2015, ADA compliant, move-in ready

Space for PPS programs & co-located CBO partners

Strategic Location + Visibility

Central NE Portland, highly transit-accessible

Adjacent to Albina Vision Trust revitalization efforts

Fiscal Alignment

Within voter-approved bond allocation

Immediate value, avoids cost escalations

Potential lease revenue offsets operations

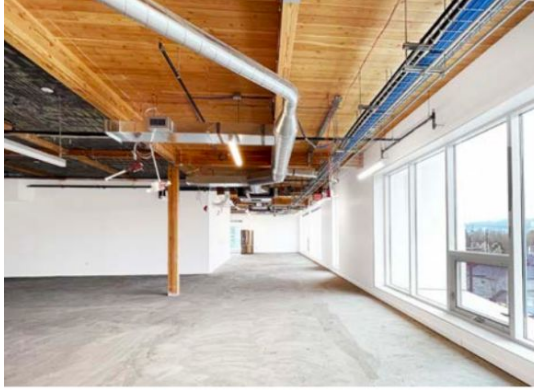
Student Access at CBSE

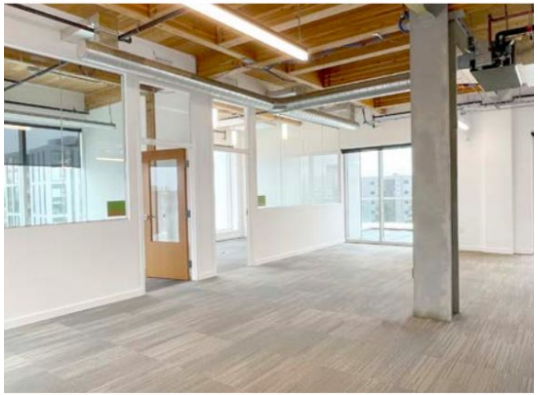
- ★ **Hub for enrichment, arts, wellness, and student leadership**
- ★ **Accessible by transit; ADA compliant**
- ★ **Programmatic, not a traditional school site**
- ★ **Flexible space: after-school, weekend, summer**

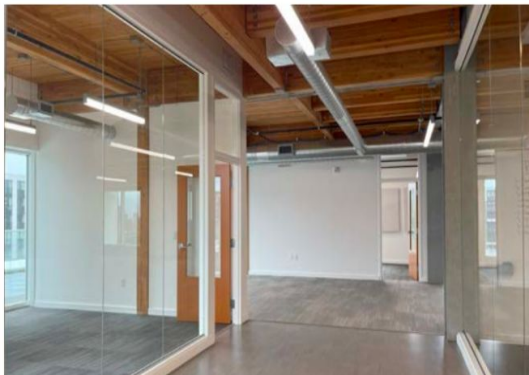


Educational Programming: What's Possible at CBSE?

- ★ Create + Innovate Lab: MakerSpace, STEAM Lab, Art & Multimedia Studios
- ★ Student Pathways: K–5 "Spark Imagination," 6–8 "Ignite Passion," 9–12 "Launch Your Future"
- ★ Hands-On Learning: Robotics, coding, design, music & video production, podcasting
- ★ Career & College Prep: Internships, mentorships, certifications, postsecondary readiness
- ★ Showcase & Outreach: Student-run store/gallery, STEAM fairs, community exhibitions

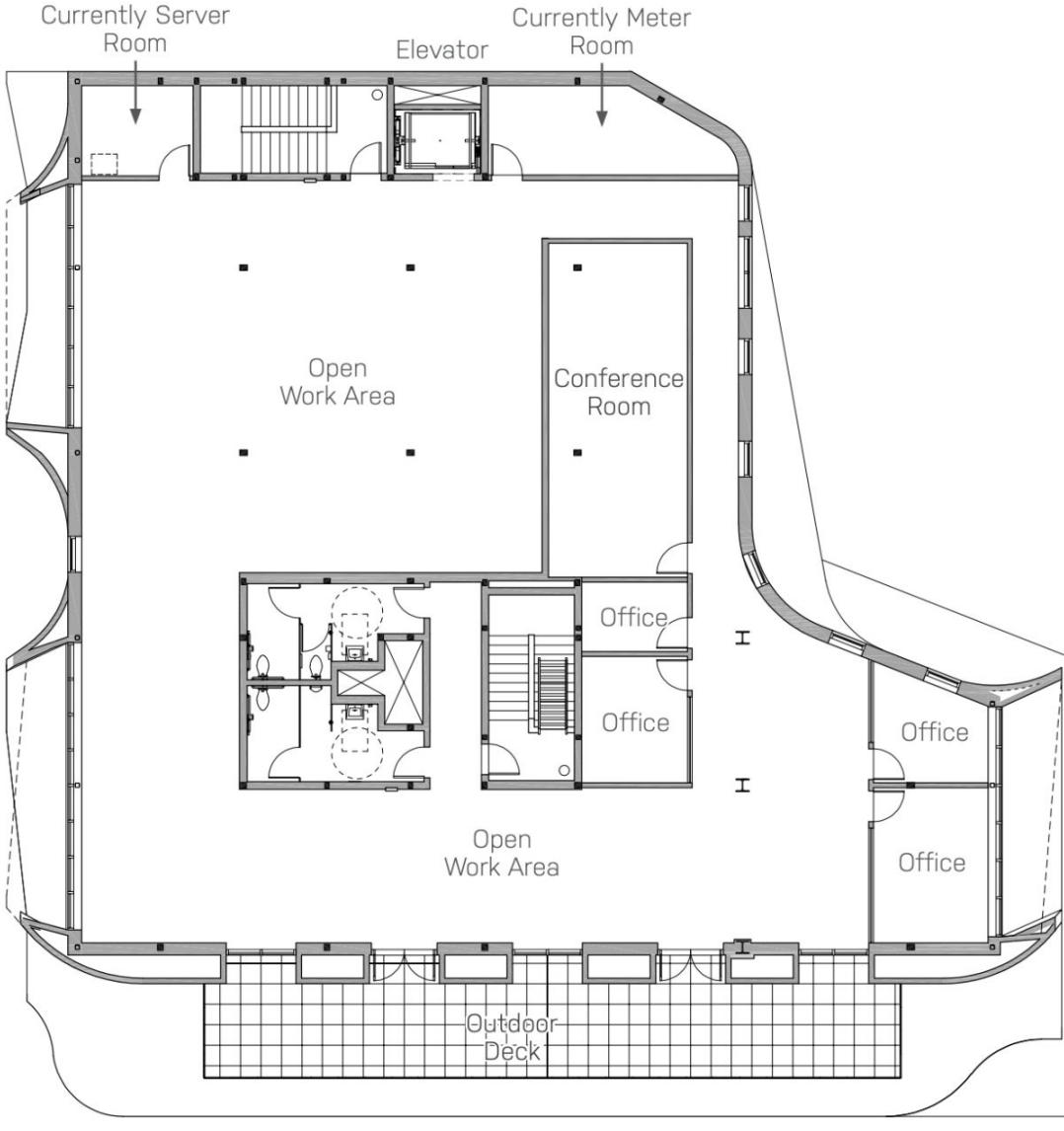




Community & Co-Location at CBSE

- ★ **Shared home for PPS & trusted CBO partners**
- ★ **Resource Hub + Satellite Offices**
- ★ **Anchored in Albina's revitalization efforts**
- ★ **Potential for lease revenue + sustainability**



Risks + Mitigation

What We Know, What We're Managing

Transportation / Load Zones (GT & ST)

GT: General Transportation (I.e. Big Buses); ST: Special Transportation (I.e. SpEd buses)

What We Know: The building sits between a commuter and commercial roadways which are not permitted for school load zones for PPS's General Transportation (GT) and Special Transportation (ST) vehicle needs.

Mitigation: Collaborate with the City of Portland to explore alternate curbside or nearby drop-off arrangements, and partner with CBOs like Oregon Walks to establish a "Walking School Bus" for schools within walking distance (e.g., Boise-Eliot Humboldt, KairosPDX). Because CBSE is not a traditional school site, but a programmatic and event-based hub, student use is limited and not dependent on daily bus service.

Alleyway is City-Owned and Slated for Public Improvements

What We Know: The alley separating the east and west parcels is a City-owned right-of-way and part of a future improvement corridor. The alley also presents a potential security concern, depending on contract language with CBOs or partners, as it could allow for commingling between students and the general public.

Mitigation: Engage City bureaus early to understand planned improvements, secure right-of-use agreements, and ensure long-term access for CBSE operations. PPS has a strong track record of navigating City planning processes, and this creates an opportunity to partner in shaping access infrastructure that will serve both the Center and the wider community.

Risks + Mitigation

What We Know, What We're Managing

Parking Limitations

What We Know: The east parcel has <10 stalls; the west parcel has none. Temporary access to the adjacent church lot will expire in 2 years.

Mitigation: Focus on off-site and shared-use parking agreements with nearby partners, while incentivizing employee and public transit use. Though on-site parking is limited, urban accessibility is a strength, this site reflects PPS values of walkability, sustainability, and transit-oriented access.

Commercial Tenants / PPS as Landlord

What We Know: PPS would inherit active commercial leases on site, introducing operational complexity and tenant oversight responsibilities.

Mitigation: Develop a property management strategy or outsource to a third-party administrator. While this adds operational responsibility, it also creates a revenue-generating opportunity for PPS, with tenant leases helping to offset costs and support the Center's long-term sustainability.

Next Steps & Recommendations

November 2025
- Conclude due diligence (feasibility, parking, tenant management, City coordination) and Finalize property management strategy (leases + partner co-location)

December 2025
- Board approval of Purchase & Sale Agreement (PSA) for One North property
- Close on property, begin tenant improvement planning

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